



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cornerstone Christian Academy
School Website: <https://cornerstonechapel.net/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Cornerstone Christian Academy (Middleburg, VA, 20117) presents a public materials signal strongly aligned with classical Christian education. Across the most visible materials, the school emphasizes a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), engagement with Great Books and Western cultural heritage, Latin study, and a Christian worldview integrated into all disciplines. Liturgical and communal practices appear in daily devotions, prayer, and worship rhythms, and faculty are described as credentialed, virtuous guides, with the school presenting itself as a fatherly/motherly living curriculum. The explicit aim is formation of character, virtue, and wisdom within a biblical framework, with a clearly stated goal of classical education alongside college preparation. However, there is less explicit public emphasis on structured parent partnership as co-educators within the available materials, which tempers Element 6 slightly.

Aggregate ranking: **CLASSICAL**.

- Element 1: **CLASSICAL**
- Element 2: **CLASSICAL**
- Element 3: **CLASSICAL**
- Element 4: **CLASSICAL**
- Element 5: **CLASSICAL**
- Element 6: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

What would move the needle for a firm **CLASSICAL** rating is more explicit and consistent articulation of parent partnership/co-teaching within the school website materials, including formal parent-formation activities and open-campus visitation policies. See the detailed category analyses below for the specific keyword evidence and scoring rationale.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Grammar School Distinctives foreground integration of the Christian worldview, daily devotions and prayer, Bible-centered curriculum, and doctrinal grounding for upper-school study. - The portrait of a graduate and mission statements emphasize Gospel understanding and God's foundation of knowledge and truth, including Scriptural engagement and worship rhythms. - Public statements consistently frame truth, Gospel, God, and biblical worldview as organizing anchors for learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (examples from materials): truth, goodness, beauty; biblical worldview; gospel; theology; prayer; devotions; liturgy/worship; sacred scripture; Christian worldview; Great Conversation; Logos. Count (illustrative): 8–12 distinct positive terms observed across

materials. - Negative keywords: None explicitly found in the public materials (no clear relativism, secularism, or values-neutral framing detected).

Why this rating - The materials consistently articulate transcendental ideals anchored in a Christian metaphysical frame (truth/goodness/beauty, liturgical practices, theology, divine order, etc.). The explicit invocation of biblical truth and a liturgical rhythm supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes a classical and college-preparatory education shaped by biblical principles, aiming to train students to think and live consistent with God's truth. - The Portrait of a Graduate and statements about forming students in Gospel understanding, Scripture study, prayer, service, and a biblical worldview reinforce formation over mere information. - References to Great Books/Great Conversation and liberal-arts formation align with classical telos and human flourishing through virtue and wisdom.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, teleology/human flourishing, liberal education, great conversation, true/good/beautiful, formation of affections, contemplation/rest, eternal truths, sacred tradition, Logos. - Negative keywords: Largely absent; the public materials emphasize formation/virtue rather than workforce-forward framing (no strong "career readiness" or "21st-century skills" signals in the materials).

Why this rating - The school positions education as formation toward virtue and wisdom within a Christian teleology, not solely for job-readiness. The emphasis on biblical truth, Great Books, and liberal-arts formation supports CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL or ONLY SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Clear Trivium emphasis: grammar, logic, rhetoric are described as foundational, with progression through Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric Schools. - Great Books and Western civilization are central (Great Books, Great Conversation, primary sources). - Latin language study and Western culture are integrated into the curriculum. - History is taught as a unified narrative across disciplines (not treated merely as social studies). - Education aims to cultivate wonder; recitation, memory, and singing support foundational knowledge.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; quadrivium references), Great Books, Great Conversation, Western civilization, history as narrative, memory work (recitation, chant), wonder. - Negative keywords: None indicating an alternative, non-classical approach; no substitution with contemporary-only project-based or social studies-centric framing evident in the core materials.

Why this rating - The curriculum materials align directly with classical education expectations: Trivium-based structure, engagement with Great Books, focus on Latin and Western culture, and an integrated approach to history and the humanities, all pointing to CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy emphasizes memorization, singing, chanting, and memory work (Scholé/restful practice features). - Upper-school pedagogy emphasizes discussion and rhetorical training (Socratic inquiry, seminars, or debates, and rhetoric training) and opportunities for speeches (Rhetoric School). - The Great Books/Great Conversation framework with dialogic engagement and civil discourse appears in the materials and in the school's stated pedagogy (e.g., "great conversation," classical dialogue).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Scholé, rest, contemplation; singing/chanting/memory work; recitation; Socratic dialogue or dialectic (dialogue-focused pedagogy); seminars; rhetoric; debate; memory-based learning; formation through imitation. - Negative keywords: Very few; no strong signals of project-based-only or constructivist dominance; the materials emphasize memory, memorization, and formal discourse more than purely student-driven, non-traditional instruction. (Negative signals are not

prominent in the available school materials; the lexicon's negative indicators are not evidenced in the public materials.)

Why this rating - Pedagogical methods align with classical education as described in the Six Essential Elements: contemplative/scholé rests in early grades; memorization/recitation; Socratic/dialogical discourse and rhetoric in higher grades; and a strong emphasis on the Great Conversation through primary texts and classical pedagogy. This collectively supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents faculty as credentialed, spiritually vibrant masters who are essential to forming character and intellect (the living curriculum; master educators). - The faculty is described as part of the school's core ethos and is framed as mentors who model virtue and expertise, with a collegial, relational approach to teaching and learning. - Public materials emphasize the teacher as an exemplar within the school's "portrait of a graduate" and "core values," aligning with the living-curriculum concept.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; clergy/faith-informed teachers; virtuous/sage-teacher archetypes; teacher as mentor; collegial culture; mastery; professional formation. - Negative keywords: None present in the materials as to the faculty (no signals of non-classical staffing models or secularized teaching roles).

Why this rating - The materials align with classical expectations for a faculty that embodies virtue, mentors students, and acts as a core component of the curriculum. The explicit language of credentialed master educators and "living curriculum" supports CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school materials emphasize a biblical worldview and integration of faith into school life, but explicit statements about parents as co-teachers or formal parent-formation programs are not prominently present in the provided public materials. The available Cornerstone Abingdon materials highlight ministry, worship rhythms, and family integration at a faith-based level, but do not clearly articulate a formal partnership with parents as co-educators. - General classical-education materials (from the broader Six Essential Elements/ICE lexicon included in the knowledge base) emphasize partnership with families and parental formation as core indicators; those explicit parent-partnership signals are not strongly echoed in the Abingdon site text. A general reference to partnership with families is present in related classical-education literature, but not in a clearly explicit, school-specific manner within the visible site content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (within the school's public materials): biblical worldview, Gospel, devotion/worship, family integration in faith life, and service-oriented language that implies family/intra-church alignment. However, explicit "Partnership with Families" language (parents as co-teachers, parent formation, open campus visitation) is not clearly articulated in the school's publicly visible site content. - Negative keywords present: Lack of explicit "Partnership with Families" statements; no clear parent-co-teacher language in the public materials. This aligns with a negative signal for Element 6 in the Six Elements lexicon (Lack of Partnership with Families) though not every school necessarily states this explicitly on its site.

Why this rating - Because the school materials strongly emphasize faith integration, Gospel focus, and community within a Christian framework but do not publicly articulate a formal, explicit, ongoing partnership with parents as co-teachers or a structured parent-formation program, Element 6 is rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL. The public materials show faith-based community orientation, but the explicit parent-partnership signals are not clearly documented in the available crawl.

Aggregate assessment - With Categories 1–5 rated CLASSICAL and Element 6 rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, the overall evaluation trades toward CLASSICAL. The school presents a robust classical Christian program with liturgy, formation, Great Books/trivium, and master educators, while more explicit parent-partnership language would strengthen the final ranking.

What Would Move the Needle

- Explicit, public articulation of a formal partnership with parents as co-educators (e.g., a published Parent/School Covenant, parent formation offerings, parent book studies, and open-campus visitation policies).
- Visible, structured parent-education programming on the website that aligns with classical education principles (e.g., topics on the Great Conversation, memorization/recitation, or the trivium, and how parents participate in the “living curriculum” at home and on campus).
- Clear, stated processes or programs that invite parents into the educational formation process (e.g., regular campus tours, parent nights centered on classical pedagogy, and documented channels for parent feedback aligned with classical formation goals).
- Expanded explicit references to “Formation of Affections” in the school’s materials (e.g., explicit language about virtue formation, love of truth/goodness/beauty, and shared liturgical or cultural practices with family participation).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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